From Everyone's Opinion to a Shared Starting Point

The family's seven steps before a care decision, in order, with a line for who does each and by when.

The goal: before anyone compares options, the family has one page showing what your loved one wants in their own words, what each relative hopes for and can do, where you agree, where you don't, and which questions are still open.

Share the list. More than one relative can take a part. Put a name and a day next to each step, and tick it when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Ask your loved one what matters most to them. Write down what they say, in their words, with the day.			
2. Write down the routines and choices they want kept, and read the list back to them.			
3. Ask each relative involved what worries them most and what outcome they hope for. Give every answer the same space.			
4. Put your loved one's wishes and the family's preferences on separate parts of the page. Anything a relative says on their behalf goes with the family's.			
5. Write down where expectations conflict, in words each person would call fair. Don't settle it.			
6. Ask each relative what they can and cannot realistically do, and write it next to what they hope for.			
7. List the questions that need a doctor, a nurse or another professional. Beside each, write the name of the relative who will ask.			

You're done when

Your loved one's wishes are written down apart from the family's preferences, the differences that haven't settled are on the page as they stand, and each open question has a name beside it. What comes after that isn't on this list: agreeing on what the choice will rest on, any professional review, and the decision itself.

If a conversation gets stuck

- If your loved one doesn't want to talk about it today, write “not yet” and ask again another day. Don't fill in for them.
- If two relatives can't agree on how to word a difference, write both versions. “We see this differently” is a finished line.
- A worry about your loved one's health goes to their doctor or nurse. It doesn't have to wait for this list to be finished.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. It doesn't settle the disagreement, say whether your loved one is safe, choose an option, or stand in for the professionals who assess their situation.

Ready for the next step?

You've worked through the family's part, one conversation at a time. The care interview takes it from there: it goes through your loved one's situation area by area with you, so the family's priorities rest on the whole picture, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›